

Annual Infrastructure Health Assessment

Ardent ISD | 2026-27

Executive Summary

Ardent ISD's infrastructure is generally stable, but three areas require leadership attention during the next budget cycle: aging wireless infrastructure at two campuses, a growing concentration of student devices entering their fifth year of service, and a help desk backlog that spikes during August and January.

The district should prioritize a phased wireless refresh, protect the planned student-device replacement allocation, and adjust seasonal support capacity before adding new districtwide platforms.

District Snapshot

Indicator	Current Position	Leadership Interpretation
Enrollment	12,480 students; 1,640 staff	Planning assumption: 2.5% annual enrollment growth for the next three years.
Internet capacity	10 Gbps primary / 5 Gbps secondary	Peak observed utilization is 61%; capacity is adequate, but redundancy should remain part of continuity planning.
Wireless	612 access points	148 access points are in or approaching the district's replacement window.
Student devices	13,220 assigned and spare devices	3,860 devices are entering year 5 and should be addressed in the next refresh cycle.
Staff devices	1,810 devices	Most are within a four-year lifecycle; 275 are scheduled for replacement.
Help desk	18,742 tickets in prior 12 months	Median first response is 4.1 business hours; seasonal backlog remains the main service concern.
Core systems	SIS, finance/payroll, SSO, LMS, VoIP, filtering, MDM	System dependencies should be maintained in the disaster recovery documentation.

Evidence Review

Network and Wi-Fi

- Internet utilization is not currently the district's primary bottleneck.
- North Ridge Middle School and Ardent High School show the highest density-related wireless complaints.
- Two MDF/IDF spaces need environmental and UPS lifecycle review before the next equipment refresh.
- Network monitoring should continue to distinguish internet capacity problems from local Wi-Fi, filtering, device, and application issues.

Device Lifecycle

- 29% of the student fleet will be in year 5 by the end of the school year.
- 11% of staff devices are scheduled for replacement.

- Spare-pool levels vary by campus; two campuses operate below the district's 4% target.
- Equity review should consider not only device-to-student ratios, but age, condition, accessibility needs, and availability of loaner/spare devices.

Help Desk and User Experience

- 82% of tickets met the current first-response target.
- Password/account, classroom display, and student-device issues represent the largest recurring categories.
- Ticket spikes align with school opening, semester transition, and major application changes.
- A seasonal staffing and communications plan should be tested before changing SLA targets.

Priority Actions

Priority	Action	Owner(s)	Target
1	Complete wireless validation and phased refresh plan for Ardent High School and North Ridge MS.	CTO, Network Services, vendor/consultant as needed	Q2
2	Protect funding for the year-5 student device cohort and align replacements to the district budget calendar.	CTO, Finance, Purchasing	Budget adoption
3	Create seasonal help desk surge plan and publish top recurring self-service resolutions.	IT Operations, Communications	Before August opening
4	Review UPS age and environmental readiness in all MDF/IDF spaces.	Network Services, Facilities	Q3
5	Update critical-system dependency map and verify restore-test schedule.	CTO, Systems, Security	Q2

Leadership Questions

1. Which risks are most likely to interrupt teaching, learning, safety, or business operations?
2. Which findings require capital investment versus changes in process or staffing?
3. Are our replacement assumptions financially sustainable for the next three years?
4. What evidence will we review next year to determine whether conditions improved?

Reference Points

- [CoSN IT Management Resources](#) - K-12 technology operations and leadership resources.
- [USAC E-Rate Program](#) - Federal E-Rate program information for schools and libraries.
- [SETDA Infrastructure for the Future](#) - Guidance for future-ready broadband and infrastructure planning.
- [Future Ready Schools Frameworks](#) - Systems-oriented planning connecting infrastructure, learning, leadership, budget, and equity.

Leadership use: This document is designed to support district-level review, discussion, and decision-making. Technical validation, procurement review, legal review, or compliance review should be completed by the appropriate district specialists when applicable.